

ANGEL ACTION · BITES & STINGS

Snake Bite — Pressure Immobilisation

For any suspected snake bite in Australia, call 000 and apply a pressure immobilisation bandage from the bite site up the entire limb, then splint and keep the patient completely still.

What to do (assume venomous)

1. **Call 000.**
2. Follow **DRSABCD**.
3. Keep the patient **absolutely still** and lying down. Movement spreads venom.
4. Apply a **pressure immobilisation bandage**:
 - Use a broad heavy-crepe bandage (or torn clothing if needed).
 - Start over the bite site, wrapping firmly — as tight as a sprain bandage.
 - Continue **up the entire limb**, covering as much as possible.
 - Mark the bite site on the outside of the bandage.
1. **Splint** the limb to prevent any movement.
2. Note the time of bite and time bandage applied.
3. Reassure and monitor. Be ready to start **CPR**.

Do NOT

- Do **not** wash the bite — venom on the skin helps identify the snake.
- Do **not** cut or suck the wound.
- Do **not** apply a tourniquet.
- Do **not** remove the bandage — only paramedics or hospital staff do this.
- Do **not** try to catch or kill the snake.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*